

Dear Jen,

It was great to talk to you forever last night. I really enjoyed listening to Mason's antics as he successfully demolished the entire house in two hours. Cool. For some reason I applaud him for being a little monster. That is what he is supposed to be. That is what all little boys are supposed to be.

I actually got another letter from you today. What a surprise. That makes two days in a row that I have gotten mail from you and that makes me very happy. So, it's too bad that the little embryo doesn't want to let us know what sex it is... Well, we will just have to devise a strategy for dealing with the difficult little tyke. I suggest we just name the baby "Mystery." That should cover us in either case, but I get the feeling that you think it is going to be a girl. Then let me being. Naming a girl is significantly more difficult than naming a boy because you have to think of any possible connotations that the name might have—but I still want to think of something original. OK, so no Candy, Trixy, or Bubbles for a girl. I like the name Anastasia and Christiana. For a boy, I like the name Dominick. The name Mason is already taken so I don't think that we should use it again. It would be pretty ridiculous to have Mason and Mason II.

Anyhow, back to reality. Baghdad was hot and hazy again today, but the temperatures have plummeted to a frigid 96 degrees this evening. We also got an air conditioner installed in the Lieutenants suite today. I am looking forward to the cool, comforting air tonight. As for the TOC, it has been business as usual today. We have not had any activity at all.

With so little going on, we have to find ways to pass the time. Today, SSG Franklin and I worked to try and restore rank and order to our operation. Specialist Viers is our RTO, and he enjoys taking long breaks and tends to disappear for long periods of time. Today we got creative. When he left for twenty minutes at the beginning of our shift we decided to implement a new program. We will allocate him one hour of time each day to do whatever he wants—this, however, includes eating dinner, cigarette breaks, and having to go to the bathroom. Ah ha. Since he was gone for twenty minutes already, we just subtracted that from his time, leaving him with forty more minutes to waste. Dinner was at four and he took the full, remaining forty minutes. Well hell. Since then we have kept him stuck at the desk. His response has been a constant haranguing about how the TOC is supposed to operate. He has even resorted to labeling different chairs and setting them up around the radio desk. One for the lieutenant, one for the NCO, and one for the Battle Captain. So guess what? I am sitting in the Lieutenant chair and he is now answering the radio. Fine with me.

Yeah, the 2-70 sector has been peaceful all day, and I don't think that we have had to work through a single issue. It has not been this way for everyone though.